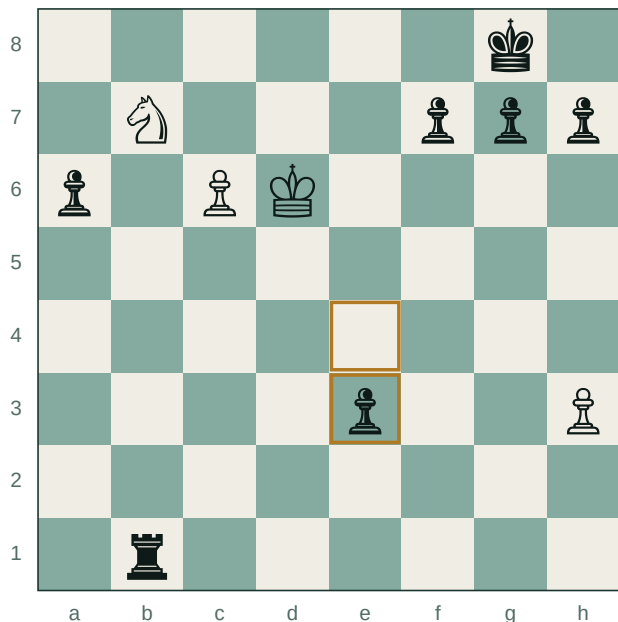


Active defensive resources: White, move 44

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 43...e3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44. c7 Rd1+ 45. Kc6 h6 46. c8=Q+

44.c7 The pawn moves from c6 to c7. Recorded reply: **44...Rd1+**.

45.Kc6 The king moves from d6 to c6. Recorded reply: **45...h6**.

46.c8=Q+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -5 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b1. Check for tactical protection.